In my capacity as director of the Mossad, I was quite involved in the subject and in the peace process with Jordan. The person who bore the main burden of negotiating with the Jordanians on behalf of the Mossad was Mossad's deputy director Efraim Halevy, whose role and contribution to the peace process were crucial.

The communications between King Hussein and the prime minister of Israel, whether it was Yitzhak Shamir or Yitzhak Rabin, spoke of Halevy as "our trusted emissary," who faithfully delivered messages back and forth between the two sides. And this trusted emissary at a certain point became "our trusted negotiator." This is a lesson that shows that the messenger does not necessarily "get shot" by the end of the process. Sometimes one can go from being a mere go-between to being a negotiator with one's own input into the process. Many times, at crisis points, of which there were many, the emissary was the one who was able to suggest ideas that bridged the gap and made it possible to continue negotiations.

The genuine smiles on Hussein and Rabin's faces in the famous photographs that epitomize the Jordanian-Israeli peace process in the eyes of the public did not necessarily characterize the period of the negotiations. This stage came only at the end of the process. There were times when suspicion and disappointment overcame trust and hope, and things even became hostile now and then.

As an illustration, let us return to the year 1993 and examine it in more detail. Throughout the year contact was maintained, messages were conveyed and negotiations were held. Everything was done in complete secrecy. The king's situation was very difficult: the United States, which did not forget his support for Saddam Hussein during the Gulf crisis, turned its back on him and made his life miserable. It imposed a closure on the port of Aqaba as part of the blockade of Iraq and inspected every ship on its way to Jordan. Egypt and Saudi Arabia also took a stance against the king because of his position in the Gulf War. Despite all this, and perhaps in part because of it, he continued to negotiate with Israel but implored for the contacts to remain secret. Throughout the negotiations in 1993, Hussein would occasionally say to his Israeli interlocutors, "Something is happening with the Palestinians." The Israelis would reply that this was not the case. The king continued to insist that something was developing on the Palestinian issue, and the Israelis continued to insist that they knew nothing. Then Hussein said, "I am telling you that things are happening in Oslo." The